

Proofs of Selected Examples from The Theory of
Partitions

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Chapter 1

Example 1

Proposition. The number of partitions of n in which each part appears two, three, or five times equals the number of partitions of n into parts congruent to 2, 3, 6, 9 or 10 modulo 12.

Lemma 1. A positive integer is congruent to 2, 3, 6, 9 or 10 modulo 12 iff it is an odd multiple of 2 or an odd multiple of 3.

Proof of Lemma 1. The odd residue classes modulo 12 are [1], [3], [5], [7], [9], and [11]. An odd multiple of 2 has the form $2m$, where m is odd. Thus the possible residue classes of $2m$ are

$$\begin{aligned} 2[1] &= 2[7] = [2], \\ 2[3] &= 2[9] = [6], \\ 2[5] &= 2[11] = [10]. \end{aligned}$$

An odd multiple of 3 has the form $3m$, where m is odd. Thus the possible residue classes of $3m$ are

$$\begin{aligned} 3[1] &= 3[5] = 3[9] = [3], \\ 3[3] &= 3[7] = 3[11] = [9]. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the odd multiples of 2 or 3 are exactly the integers congruent to 2, 3, 6, 9, or 10 modulo 12. ■

Proof of the Proposition. Let $p_\alpha(n)$ denote the number of partitions of n in which each part appears two, three, or five times. Let $p_\beta(n)$ denote the number of partitions of n into parts congruent to 2, 3, 6, 9, or 10 modulo 12. Thus

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} p_\alpha(n) q^n = \prod_{n \geq 1} (1 + q^{2n} + q^{3n} + q^{5n})$$

and, by Lemma 1

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} p_\beta(n) q^n = \prod_{n \geq 1} \frac{1}{(1 - q^{2(2n-1)})(1 - q^{3(2n-1)})}.$$

Finally

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{n \geq 0} p_\beta(n) q^n &= \prod_{n \geq 1} \frac{1 - q^{4n}}{1 - q^{2n}} \cdot \frac{1 - q^{6n}}{1 - q^{3n}} \\ &= \prod_{n \geq 1} (1 + q^{2n}) (1 + q^{3n}) \\ &= \prod_{n \geq 1} (1 + q^{2n} + q^{3n} + q^{5n}) \\ &= \sum_{n \geq 0} p_\alpha(n) q^n. \end{aligned} \quad \blacksquare$$

Example 2

Proposition. The number of partitions of n in which only odd parts may be repeated, here denoted $p_o(n)$, equals the number of partitions of n in which no part is repeated more than three times, here denoted $p_3(n)$.

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{n \geq 0} p_o(n) q^n &= \prod_{n \geq 1} (1 + q^{2n}) \left(\frac{1}{1 - q^{2n-1}} \right) \\ &= \prod_{n \geq 1} \left(\frac{1 - q^{4n}}{1 - q^{2n}} \right) \left(\frac{1}{1 - q^{2n-1}} \right) \\ &= \frac{\prod_{n \geq 1} (1 - q^{4n})}{\prod_{n \geq 1} (1 - q^{2n})(1 - q^{2n-1})} \\ &= \prod_{n \geq 1} \frac{1 - q^{4n}}{1 - q^n} \\ &= \sum_{n \geq 0} p_3(n) q^n. \quad \blacksquare\end{aligned}$$

Example 3

Proposition. The number of partitions of n in which only parts $\not\equiv 0 \pmod{2^m}$ may be repeated, here denoted $p_\alpha(n)$, equals the number of partitions of n in which no part appears more than $2^{m+1} - 1$ times, here denoted $p_\beta(n)$.

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{n \geq 0} p_\alpha(n) q^n &= \prod_{n \geq 1} (1 + q^{2^m n}) \left(\frac{1 - q^{2^m n}}{1 - q^n} \right) \\ &= \prod_{n \geq 1} (1 + q^{2^m n}) (1 + q^n + \dots + q^{(2^m - 1)n}) \\ &= \prod_{n \geq 1} (1 + q^n + \dots + q^{(2^{m+1} - 1)n}) \\ &= \prod_{n \geq 1} \frac{1 - q^{2^{m+1} n}}{1 - q^n} \\ &= \sum_{n \geq 0} p_\beta(n) q^n. \quad \blacksquare \end{aligned}$$